

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability
	Part No./Name	O – Disaster Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (DSNAP)
	Section No./Name	O-400-DSNAP Eligibility Requirements
	Document No./Name	O-470-DSNAP Income/Resource Test
	Effective Date	September 1, 2022

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

Total countable household income and total accessible household liquid resources, minus allowable disaster-related expenses that will not be reimbursed during the DSNAP benefit period, are compared to the DSNAP Gross Income Limit to determine DSNAP eligibility.

The DSNAP Gross Income Limit is equal to the sum of the maximum monthly net income limit for the regular SNAP plus the standard income deduction and the maximum shelter deduction for the regular SNAP. The DSNAP Gross Income Limits for each disaster will be specified on the DSNAP Worksheet ([DIS 2](#)).

O-471-DSNAP INCOME

For DSNAP purposes, income is defined as the DSNAP household's earned and unearned income received or reasonably expected to be received during the DSNAP benefit period.

For earned income, count "take-home pay". "Take-home pay" is defined as the net wages a household actually receives after taxes and all other payroll withholding. Payroll withholding includes any deductions from wages, such as insurance premiums, retirement contributions, garnishments, automatic payments to creditors, etc. Money received on payroll deposit debit cards is considered earned income.

EXAMPLE: The DSNAP applicant's gross earned income is \$1,500. The payroll deductions for taxes, retirement, and insurance are a total of \$500. The net earnings shown on his paycheck are \$1,000. This amount is directly deposited into his checking account. Immediately upon deposit, the financial institution transfers \$100 to his savings account (accessible) and \$200 to a loan payment. The applicant also has automatic drafts set up to pay his cell phone and utility bills on a designated date each month. These payments are not associated with the date of the direct deposit of the applicant's paycheck. The \$200 transfer for the loan payment is not included in the applicant's "take-home pay" since it is automatically transferred when the paycheck is deposited and it is not accessible to the client. However, the \$100 transferred into the applicant's savings account is included in the "take-home pay" since it is transferred into an accessible account. The automatic drafts to pay the cell phone and utility bills are not payroll withholdings and are therefore included in the applicant's "take-home pay". Thus, the applicant's "take-home pay" is \$800. (Payroll deposit of \$1,000 minus \$200 transfer to loan payment = \$800.)

For self-employment income, the costs of producing the income are also subtracted.

For unearned income, count the net income. Countable unearned income types include but are not limited to:

- Social Security benefits,

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- SSI,
- child support,
- pensions,
- UCB,
- workers' compensation,
- cash donations or contributions from friends, families, and other non-governmental sources,
- the value of credit card company gift cards or prepaid debit cards, and
- FITAP/KCSP benefits.

Unearned income types excluded in the regular SNAP are also excluded in the DSNAP. Disaster payments provided as a result of a presidentially-declared emergency or major disaster are excluded in the DSNAP. This includes federal assistance provided to persons directly affected and to comparable disaster assistance provided by states, local governments, and disaster assistance organizations. This includes Individual and Family Grant (IFG) payments, Red Cross payments, Small Business Administration (SBA) loans, and Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) payments. Disaster relief employment funded under National Energy grants, Disaster Insurance payments and Disaster Unemployment Assistance are excluded in the DSNAP.

Income received more frequently than monthly is not converted to a monthly figure as is done in the regular SNAP. Actual income received or expected to be received during the DSNAP benefit period is counted, regardless of the frequency of payments.

EXAMPLE: The disaster benefit period is September 4 through October 3. A household applies on September 13. The applicant is normally paid on the 5th and 25th of each month. His employer has evacuated and he is unable to contact him. He does not anticipate receiving a paycheck on September 25. Only the take-home pay from the paycheck of September 5 would be counted since he does not reasonably expect to receive a paycheck on September 25.

O-472-DSNAP RESOURCES

Liquid resources as of the first day of the DSNAP benefit period are considered in the DSNAP eligibility determination, but there is no separate resource test for DSNAP purposes. Liquid resources include but are not limited to:

- cash on hand,

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- money in checking or savings accounts,
- money in a money market account that is available and accessible, or the value of credit card company gift cards or prepaid debit cards.

To be countable, these liquid resources must be accessible to the DSNAP household (e.g., money in a checking account in a bank that is closed and has no ATM operations is considered inaccessible and is not counted).

All non-liquid resources are excluded from the DSNAP eligibility determination. Individual Retirement Accounts (IRAs), stocks, bonds, and Keogh plans are excluded.

Do not count the same money as income and a liquid resource for the same month (e.g., paycheck that is deposited into checking account).

O-473-DSNAP DISASTER-RELATED EXPENSES

Allowable disaster-related expenses are defined as disaster-related expenses that the DSNAP household has paid or reasonably expects to pay during the DSNAP benefit period, minus any reimbursements for these expenses that the DSNAP household receives or expects to receive during the DSNAP benefit period.

Note: A disaster-related expense paid using a credit card is an allowable disaster-related expense **regardless** ^{**} if the credit card bill will be paid during the DSNAP benefit period.

EXAMPLE 1: A DSNAP household had to stay in a hotel for several days during the DSNAP benefit period and paid for the hotel expense using a credit card. The credit card bill will not be paid during the DSNAP benefit period. The hotel expense is not an allowable disaster-related expense.

EXAMPLE 2: A DSNAP household loses the roof of their home during a hurricane. The household expects to repair the roof during the DSNAP benefit period, has homeowner's insurance with a \$1000 deductible, and expects to pay the \$1000 deductible during the DSNAP benefit period. The \$1000 deductible and not the entire cost of the roof repair is an allowable disaster-related expense.

EXAMPLE 3: A DSNAP household loses the roof of their home during a hurricane. The household expects to repair the roof during the DSNAP benefit period but does not have homeowner's insurance. The entire cost of the roof repair is an allowable disaster-related expense.

EXAMPLE 4: A DSNAP household loses the roof of their home during a hurricane. The household does not expect to repair the roof during the DSNAP benefit period. The cost of the roof repair is not an allowable disaster-related expense.

Disaster-related expenses that can be considered include but are not limited to:

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- food destroyed in the disaster that the household has replaced or intends to replace,
- cost to repair or replace disaster damage to home, property, or business,
- medical or funeral expenses related to the disaster,
- dependent care expenses directly due to the disaster,
- cost to repair or replace tools/equipment needed for work,
- temporary shelter expenses if unable to live at home,
- moving expenses if evacuated from home,
- expenses to protect property from disaster damage, even if purchased prior to disaster,
- disaster-related pet boarding fees,
- expenses related to replacing necessary personal and household items such as clothing, appliances, tools, and educational material,
- fuel for primary heating source,
- cost of clean-up items,
- cost to repair disaster-related damages of vehicle, and
- moving or storage expenses.

II. PROCEDURES

There are no procedures associated with this policy.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms and instructions associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

[7CFR 271.2, 273.1, 273.2 and 273.6](#)